



kdenlive

Video Editing the Easy Way, With Kdenlive

Let us explore an easy way to make awesome videos, using open source editing software called Kdenlive.

Some time back, I had an urgent task at hand. I had to shoot a video and then edit it to make it appeal to viewers. The problem was that I did not know anything about video editing; so, I began the search for the perfect software to help me edit my video. I found a number of proprietary software for the job, but being a FOSS advocate, I wanted to use open source software. Also, since this was my first attempt at editing a video, I wanted the software to be easy to use, yet loaded with a lot of functionality. My search came to an end when I came across Kdenlive.

An introduction

Kdenlive is a non-linear video editor. This means that to edit a particular frame in, say, the 30th minute of a video, you don't have to go through the entire video sequentially till you reach that part/frame—you can directly jump there.

It supports a wide range of codecs and formats, so you can mix different types of media such as audio, video or images. It has a time-line supporting unlimited video and audio tracks, which can be organised in layers. You can also configure the keyboard short-cuts and interface layouts. Video clips on DV or HDV (high definition video) camera can also be viewed directly on Kdenlive using a Firewire cable. Other salient features include tools to crop, move, delete and edit video, audio and images. When you are done editing the video, you can export it to a variety of standard formats. Kdenlive is currently supported on a variety of

operating systems such as FreeBSD, Ubuntu, Fedora, openSUSE, Mac OS X, etc.

Installation

Kdenlive can be installed easily from the Ubuntu Software Centre, or pre-compiled packages for other operating systems can be downloaded from <http://bit.ly/ieriKt>.

When you start out for the first time, follow the simple instructions in the configuration wizard. If you are not sure about which profile suits you, just select one. Once you add a clip, Kdenlive will suggest the appropriate profile.

Layout

The layout is pretty neat. You can drag, drop, maximise or resize different blocks/panes easily, like I have done (see Figure 1). When you are done, you can save that layout via **View > Save Layout As**. Now let us understand the different blocks/panes. On the top, you have your menu and below that are the buttons for frequent tasks.

The first pane I will cover is the *Project Tree*. Using this pane, you can add new images, audio or video clips to your project. You can also add a title clip, or organise your media in folders. The next is the *Transition* pane. When you try to merge two different videos together, you need to add an effect, so that shifting from one video to another looks appealing to the user. All those effects are under this pane.

The next pane is *Effect Stack*, which contains a lot of